

Five Elements Cycles Diagram

Printable. Generating + controlling, on one page.

Five Ways Energy Moves

- Wood 木 — grows and spreads (spring).
- Fire 火 — rises and transforms (summer).
- Earth 土 — holds and settles (the pivot).
- Metal 金 — cuts and refines (autumn).
- Water 水 — runs and gathers (winter).

Generating Cycle (相生) — each feeds the next

Wood → Fire (it burns) → Earth (it becomes ash) → Metal (ore forms) → Water (it melts and flows) → Wood.

Controlling Cycle (相剋) — each checks another

Wood → Earth (roots break soil) → Water (dams it) → Fire (quenches it) → Metal (melts it) → Wood (cuts it).

Read Any Chart

Which elements are present, and which are strong? Wood+fire runs “hot”; metal+water runs “cold.” Nothing is judged — each element is a different tempo.

